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In the role of the game, I played as the striving manufacturer, and with the character I had several objectives to achieve many of which could not be fulfilled. This essay will be about writing a letter to potential shareholders who are in the state of Kentucky, prominently in the cities of Louisville, Lexington and Convington who are in the industry of processing hemp and would need bagging and rope which I provide. A significant investment would help me defeat my competitors and make my business larger. Completing my objectives would make my business seem less risky from the unstable circumstances of Kentucky. This letter would be written from the time of the first half of 1861 where current events are uncertain of what will happen in the next few months.

Hello fellow Kentuckian investors, I own a steam-powered rope and bagging factory, which recently moved from horse-powered and hand weaving to modern machinery. Employing eight white workers and three free blacks, in addition to hiring 5 slaves from owners and owning 4 slaves. If war were to break out in the state of Kentucky, my business would be doomed to fail, as my factory lies in the outskirts of Kentucky and would be first to be destroyed. In spite of growing tensions between the south and the north, it is certain that any disasters that may occur during these times will be either prevented or at least kept as far away from Kentucky as possible. Thus ensuring continued trade with the north and south, which will not impact our business. There are a plethora of reasons why this scenario will never happen and why investing

in my factories is a smart move. First off quoting from Cotton is King Speech, “You dare not make war on cotton. No power on earth dares to make war upon it. Cotton is king”. I am certain that if push comes to shove the very fact that the north relies so heavily with the production of slavery from the north that any actual threats from the north invading the south would seem quite suicidal for the north. It would be very unlikely for war to erupt. In addition negotiations between the North and the South have been in the works, if John Crittenden’s amendments were to be passed the internal division between the sides would go away. In the legislature we made several compromises on it and we are confident it will pass. If amendments 1 and 5 pass, it would mean the end of the discussion, “Amendment 1 In all the territory of the United States now held, situated north of latitude 36° 30 slavery” and “No future amendment of the Constitution shall affect the five preceding articles”. These two amendments will ultimately end the heated discussion of slavery for good.

Another reason for investing in my factory is that we are moving away from slave produced work to hired work. As technology improves, more machinery is used in the process of creating products, meaning it is less useful to have slaves as, cannot do skilled labor, or at the very least will be more likely to sabotage. The best move is to hire more free workers as they can operate high skilled machinery and can be replaced easily. The owner is responsible for the cost of a slave's injury, disease, or death, whereas if a worker is injured or incapacitated, it is the worker's responsibility, a new worker can just be hired. In fact by my estimates slave labor only is about one third cheaper than using hired workers and is declining. With the resolution on immigration being passed, this will boost the people coming to the state and will allow more workers to be hired.

The summary of what objectives were achieved after the work, since my character served in the war and died at home after being wounded in battle, they could not have written a letter summing up their objectives. My character had six objectives, some were fulfilled others not. Starting off with continued trade with the deep south, this objective failed, since Kentucky chose to join the union, rather than being neutral, and the CornerStone Bill of Kentucky passed, essentially blocking trade from the frontline. The second objective: prevent spending by the legislator, also failed, for one a lot of taxes were used for the militia and for tax exemptions for freeing slaves. The third objective: pass a resolution supporting immigration which was a success as the legislature passed the law doing just that. The fourth: attain regional unanimity on secession, which was a success as the Kentucky unanimously with the union, however the inspector general, took most of the militia out of the state to join the confederacy. Fifth: protect my factory and house: was a success as my property stayed still standing, since the objectives did not mention dying. The last objective: publish my poetry at least three times: failed as I did not publish any poetry. In the end only three out of the six objectives were fulfilled.

Works Cited

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